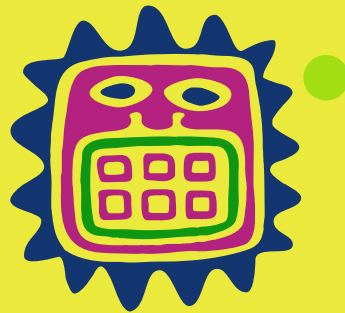
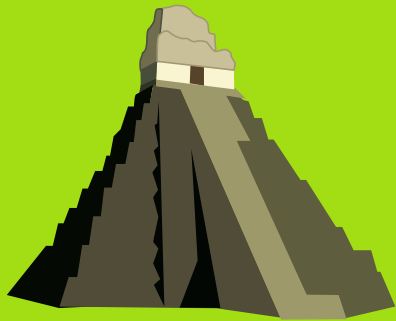
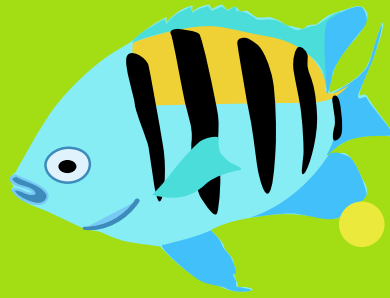




Belize

Paste
your doll's
picture
here

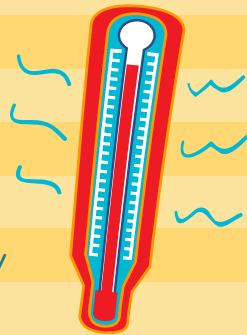
Travel Diary

Belize - Day 1



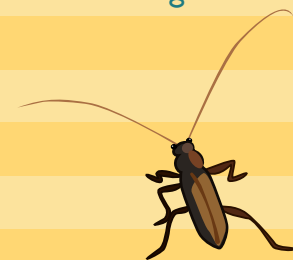
6:55 p.m.
Dear Diary,

Welcome to Belize! Our plane just landed, and I can already feel the humidity starting to fill the cabin. It's warm all year round here, and the flight attendant told me that it's a real scorcher out there today! Good thing I packed light. But one thing's for sure: the heat won't stop me from all of the things I want to do—see the rainforest, explore some caves, take a picture of a toucan, and the list goes on. This trip is going to be so awesome—you better Belize it!



9:15 p.m.
Dear Diary,

I was a little nervous when I heard we'd be staying in a hut instead of a hotel, but forget hotels—this place is way better! Our hut is actually built up in a tree, so it's more like a giant tree house. There is nothing covering the windows, so my bed has a net that drapes over the top to keep out mosquitoes (and hopefully any other creepy crawlers, too). The sounds of the insects and other rainforest creatures are so relaxing that I can barely keep my eyes open! See you in the morning.





1:43 p.m.

Dear Diary,

I found out today that the best way to see the rainforest is from a bird's-eye view! I took a canopy tour, which is a tour of the second-highest layer of the rainforest using a ZIP line. I had to swing on a cable between eight different platforms, 80 feet above the ground! Aside from wearing all the safety gear, I now know what a monkey must feel like swinging from branch to branch. At each platform I saw another new animal. On the first one, I saw a green iguana chilling out on a branch up in a tree. I also saw a black howler monkey, a coatimundi (which looks like a raccoon with a long nose), and a few tree

frogs. But the best part is that I finally got a picture of a toucan—and I'm in it, too! This is definitely going into my scrapbook when I get home.

8:35 p.m.

Dear Diary,

Being up in the treetops really wiped me out, so I took a nap outside in a hammock when we got back. I woke up feeling all full of energy—and really hungry! So we went to the Green Parrot Café for an awesome dinner. Everything had a yummy tropical taste to it. I thought pineapple was the best thing to eat in Belize, but guava-glazed ribs were just as tasty (though a whole lot messier). We're leaving our tree-house huts in the morning and heading to stay near the ocean for a day or two before we leave. I'll write more tomorrow!



Say Cheese!

Instructions: Print and paste photos of your doll's head, and color her hair to complete the picture.

Day 5



3:55 p.m.
Dear Diary,

On our way to the ocean, we stopped at the Green Hills Butterfly Ranch, where I saw more types of butterflies than I could count. There were so many different kinds in all different colors. I saw a big Blue Morpho that was almost six inches across and one called a Broad-Tipped Clearwing, whose wings you could see right through. The butterflies must've liked my yellow shirt, because at one time, I had six different butterflies on me. One even landed on my cheek, and when its wing brushed on my face, it reminded me of the butterfly kisses my mom gives me



with her eyelashes. I think it's pretty special to be kissed by a bunch of butterflies. Maybe they know I'm leaving soon and were saying good-bye.

Day 6

9:05 a.m.

Dear Diary,

Sleeping to the sounds of ocean waves crashing on the beach is really different from sleeping to the sounds of the rain-forest. I was getting used to waking up with all those parrots screeching and the monkeys whooping! Now that I'm out of bed, Coconut and I are going to head down

to the beach to see if the tide washed in any good seashells. I haven't been able to do much shopping while I've been in Belize, but seashells will make great souvenirs for my friends (and maybe some for me, too!).

11:20 a.m.

Dear Diary,

We found tons of seashells for my friends, and two I'm keeping for myself to remember Belize. One is a conch shell, and when you hold it to your ear, you can hear the ocean waves. The other is a tiny scalloped shell that has a hole in the top. When I get home, I'm going to string it on a piece of leather and wear it around my neck!

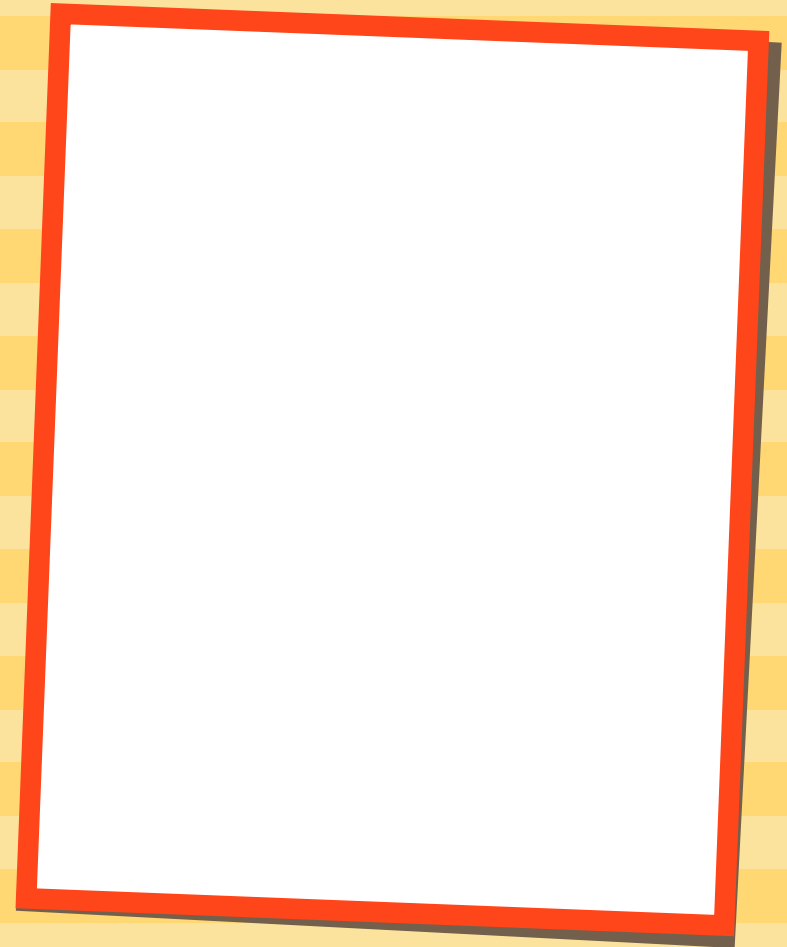


6:25 p.m.

Dear Diary,

I had a wonderful afternoon at the beach!
I swam in the ocean, threw the Frisbee to
Coconut, and built a sand castle that looked
like El Castillo! It was a perfect ending to
another fun-filled trip.

We're leaving early in the morning so I
have to pack now. I had a blast in Belize
and I only hope my next trip will be just as
much fun! See you there.



What beautiful butterflies!

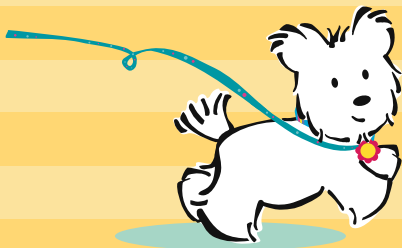
Instructions: Design and color
your own butterflies at the
butterfly ranch.



Day 2

5:40 a.m.
Dear Diary,

Sleeping in a tree makes me feel just like a bird sleeping in a nest. And, from the sounds of it, I have a lot of feathered friends living around me. I've never heard so much chirping and cawing—and all before the sun is even up! Well, since I can't hit the snooze button on the birds, I might as well take Coconut out for her morning walk.



8:25 a.m.
Dear Diary,

Guess what I've been doing? I saw a group of people practicing yoga by the river and asked if I could join them. It was hard to get into some of the different poses, but at the end, sitting in the "easy pose," which is when you sit cross-legged with a straight back, was a lot, well, easier. Then our teacher had us lie on our backs and completely relax. The setting was so beautiful with the pink and orange sunrise, and I could feel the rainforest mist on my skin. But it was a little hard to relax with all the noisy birds in the nearby trees!





10:40 a.m.
Dear Diary,

We're on a ferry headed across the Mopan River to the Maya site, Xunantunich (zoo-nan-too-nitch), which means "stone woman." The amazing thing is that the ferry has no motor—just a hand crank. I was allowed to turn the crank for a while, but my arms got tired pretty fast. It sure is a lot of work!

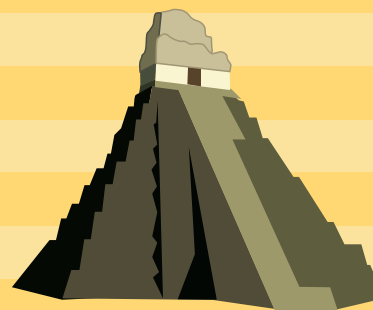
11:45 a.m.
Dear Diary,

We have a long hike to the top of the pyramid, El Castillo (cass-tee-yo), which means "the castle," so I'm eating lunch now to make sure I have energy for the climb. Beans and rice is a traditional meal here, so I decided to give it a try. It sounds kind of boring, but it is actually pretty yummy!



3:10 p.m.
Dear Diary,

The view from the top of El Castillo was so neat and totally worth the major climb. I was even able to see Guatemala, which is the country next to Belize. The colors of all the plants were so bright that it looked like everything had been dipped in different shades of green paint. Afterwards, we went into the pyramid's museum and saw a 3-D version of what the pyramid looked like when it was built, more than a thousand years ago!

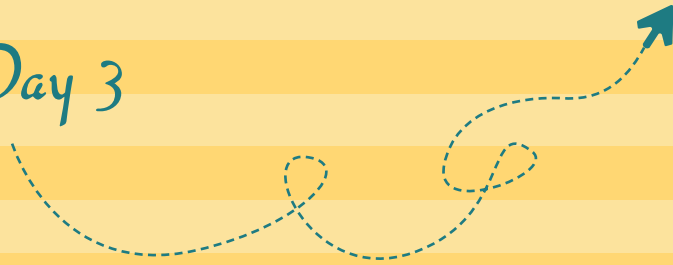




I'm sending a postcard to my best friend back home.

Activity: Write a message on the back of the card.

Day 3



10:10 a.m.

Dear Diary,

There are so many incredible things about Belize, but do you know what one of my favorites is so far? The fresh pineapple! You'd think it wouldn't be that different from the stuff from the grocery store back home, but it is. It's so juicy and sweet that I'm going to eat it every day for breakfast—and maybe a few snacks, too. Maybe I can even sneak some into my suitcase when we leave!

1:20 p.m.

Dear Diary,

I never thought the thing I'd need most on a tropical vacation would be a headlamp!



Day 3 continued...

But when you're cave tubing, it's definitely needed. This afternoon we're going to float along seven miles of a river, part of it running through dark underground caves. I can only imagine what I'm going to see, especially inside some of those caves! I'm a little nervous about bats, so I hope any that live in the caves are busy taking naps. Other than that, it should be a lot of fun. I'll tell you all about it when I get back.

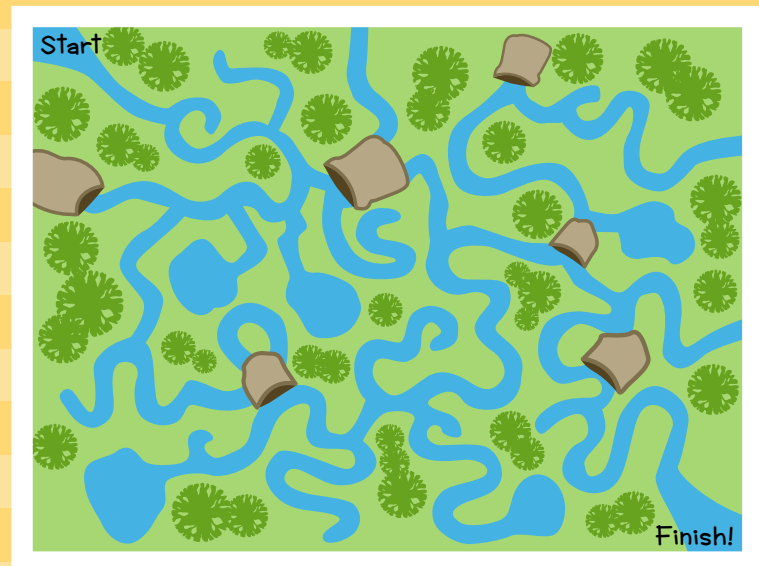
7:35 p.m.

Dear Diary,

Cave tubing rocks! When we were out in the warm sunshine, it was cool to just float along the river. But when we drifted into a cave, it got all spooky dark and full of echoes. I was turning myself every which way, trying to see. The shadows cast by



the stalactites hanging from the ceiling were a little eerie. I got goose bumps a couple of times, but maybe it was just from the temperature in the caves. It's kind of cold in there!



Go with the flow!

Instructions: Get your doll through the maze of rivers and caves to complete her tubing adventure.